INNOVATOR TEST 5

READING AND WRITING

MODULE 1

Researchers at the University of Houston have discovered a new way to _____ nuclear waste. A team led by chemistry professor Ognjen Miljanic found that certain molecular crystals can absorb radioactive iodine, a byproduct of nuclear fission. The team created the crystals using widely available chemicals in an inexpensive process, signaling a potential breakthrough in nuclear energy production.

NEXT QUESTION

1. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A manage
- B justify
- C construct
- D define

COME BACK LATER

The Mars Science Laboratory's Curiosity rover landed on Mars on August 5, 2012. In order for the mission to land successfully, NASA's aerospace engineers _____ a complex sequence of maneuvers that facilitated a decrease in the speed of the descending rover so that it could be safely lowered to the planet's surface.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

2. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

- A pondered
- B collaborated
- C hindered
- D choreographed

Tartrate crystals are a common occurrence in grape products, such as wines or grape juice, and are composed of potassium bitartrate. The formation of tartrate crystals can be attributed to the natural properties found within grapes and the fermentation process. In fact, they are often considered as a sign of _____, though a misinformed person might perceive them as a harmful additive.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

3. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

× A potency

× B efficacy

× C palatability

× D authenticity

The following text is from Frances Hodgson Burnett's 1905 novel *A Little Princess*.

> Sara often thought afterward that the house was somehow exactly like Miss Minchin. It was respectable and well furnished, but everything in it was ugly; and the very armchairs seemed to have hard bones in them. In the hall everything was hard and polished—even the red cheeks of the moon face on the tall clock in the corner had a severe varnished look. The drawing room into which they were ushered was covered by a carpet with a square pattern upon it, the chairs were square, and a heavy marble timepiece stood upon the heavy marble mantel.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

4. Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

× A It sets up an unfavorable extended comparison between Miss Minchin and her house.

× B It indicates that Sara does not like the house because it is physically unappealing.

× C It establishes from the beginning that Sara will have a strained relationship with Miss Minchin.

× D It describes how Miss Minchin's ugliness is both internal and external.

The following is adapted from the opening to Jonathan Swift's 1726 work *Gulliver's Travels*.

My father had a small estate in Nottinghamshire; I was the third of five sons. He sent me to Emanuel College at fourteen years old, where I resided three years, and applied myself closely to my studies; but the charge of maintaining me, although I had a very scanty allowance, being too great for a narrow fortune, I was bound apprentice to Mr. James Bates, an eminent surgeon in London, with whom I continued four years. My father now and then sending me small sums of money, I laid them out in learning navigation, and other parts of the mathematics, useful to those who intend to travel, as I always believed it would be, some time or other, my fortune to do.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

5. Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

× A to shift the focus from the narrator's early education and experience to his interest in exploration

× B to summarize the development of the narrator's character through various challenges

× C to explain the ways in which money has influenced and eventually corrupted the narrator

× D to argue for the central importance of education in the life of a person who wishes to become an explorer

The following paragraph is from the 1749 novel *The History* of Tom Jones, a Foundling by Henry Fielding. The passage opens a chapter in which Mr. Allworthy discovers Tom, an abandoned infant.

> I have told my reader, in the preceding chapter, that Mr. Allworthy inherited a large fortune; that he had a good heart and no family. Hence, doubtless, it will be concluded by many that he lived like an honest man, owed no one a shilling, took nothing but what was his own, kept a good house, entertained his neighbors with a hearty welcome at his table, and was charitable to the poor.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

6. Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

- ✖ A to provide behaviors that readers would assume they might find in Allworthy
- ✖ B to give a full description of the activities for which Allworthy was known
- ✖ C to indicate how readers should act if they are able to
- ✖ D to record the actions that Allworthy's neighbors typically see him doing

Text 1

According to Nicole Kay Peterson of Iowa State University, the evolution of office spaces followed a twisted path through eras and contexts. Peterson first traced the birth of individualized office areas, or cubicles, to fifth-century monasteries. She then saw evidence of modern cubicles in Italian city-states such as Florence, which developed centrally-located administrative offices in the 1500s, and British trading firms, which built offices with dedicated conference rooms in the 1700s.

Text 2

Cubed: A Secret History of the Workplace functions as a hard-edged social commentary for author Nikil Saval, who largely attributes the development of today's cubicle culture to questionable 1800s ideals. Cubicles, for Saval, offer the illusion of self-directed and fulfilling individual work but align with an approach that treats workers as the implements of corporations. Saval notes, however, that such alienation has recently begun to abate as companies embrace more communal office plans.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

7. Based on the texts, how does Nicole Kay Peterson's approach (Text 1) to the history of office spaces differ from Nikil Saval's (Text 2)?

✖ A Peterson analyzes a variety of developments without passing critical judgment, while Saval criticizes the concept of individual office space.

✖ B Peterson shows how a single period defined the physical scale of offices, while Saval argues that offices experienced uncontrolled expansion.

✖ C Peterson highlights how dissimilar cultures arrived at comparable ideas about office space, while Saval argues offices originated exclusively from one culture.

✖ D Peterson surveys historical perspectives on office space, while Saval both notes deficiencies in earlier research and develops a new perspective.

Historians of European cultures typically divide history using geographic and chronological distinctions. In contrast, when studying Asian history, historians frequently examine cultural and religious distinctions, such as Confucianism, Buddhism, Islam, or Hinduism, which extend beyond the traditional constraints of geography and time. This way of understanding history can show the development of separate cultures within a shared timeframe as well as highlight the complex interactions that arise from these interconnected histories.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

8. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

✖ A Unlike European history, Asian history is characterized by a broader perspective that deems chronology as insignificant.

✖ B History can be told in various ways, yet focusing on the culture will result in a more accurate depiction of the times compared to focusing on other factors like geography or chronology.

✖ C Studying Asian history involves examining cultural and religious distinctions that go beyond traditional geographical and chronological limitations.

✖ D Religious and cultural distinctions hold a greater significance to Asians compared to Europeans, as reflected in the specific areas that historians study for each respective group.

In the Mayan creation myth recorded in the Popul Vuh, there are four attempts at the creation of human beings, each improving on the previous iteration. This suggests a progressive process that culminates in not only humans as they are, but also in an articulation of the purpose of human life. The gods, led by Heart of Sky, wish to create beings with their own hearts and minds who choose to "keep the days," which is to live rightly in honor of the gods, and their final effort is to create humans from ground maize, which accounts for the sacred place that maize holds in Mayan culture. Juana Batz Puac, K'iche' Maya, Day Keeper, explains that, being made from maize, "It feeds our spirit as well as our bodies."

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

9. According to the text, what is the significance of maize in Mayan culture?

× A The final version of humanity was created from maize, so it has spiritual meaning.

× B The gods of Mayan mythology were grown from maize and still are present in it.

× C Maize offers the most bodily health of any food grown in Mayan cultures.

× D Growing and eating maize is the entirety of one's duty to "keep the days."

The following text is from Charlotte Brontë's 1847 novel *Jane Eyre*. It is told from the perspective of the title character.

> Mr. Rochester, on hearing the name, set his teeth; he experienced, too, a sort of strong convulsive quiver; near to him as I was, I felt the spasmodic movement of fury or despair run through his frame. The second stranger, who had hitherto lingered in the background, now drew near; a pale face looked over the solicitor's shoulder—yes, it was Mason himself. Mr. Rochester turned and glared at him. His eye, as I have often said, was a black eye; it had now a tawny, nay, a bloody light in its gloom.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

10. According to the text, what is true about Mr. Rochester?

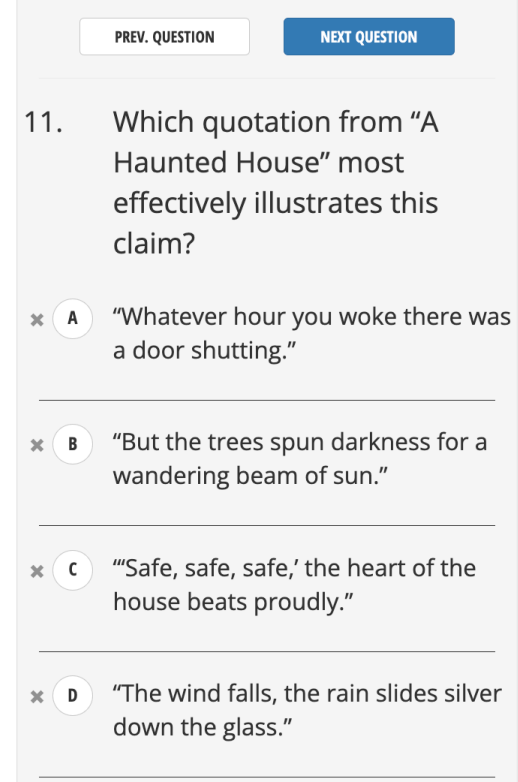
× A Mason and Mr. Rochester are long-standing enemies.

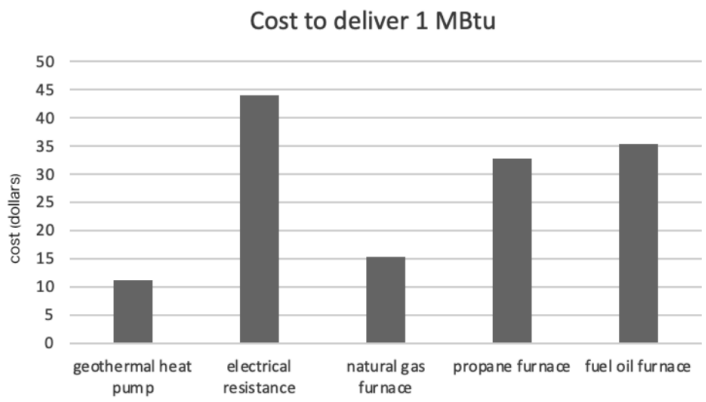
× B He is experiencing a strong emotional reaction to the presence of Mason.

× C Mr. Rochester intends to attack Mason and would do so if Jane were not present

× D He loves Jane and wants to protect her from individuals who might take advantage of her.

"A Haunted House" is a 1921 short story written by Virginia Woolf. One of the key elements of this story is the human-like qualities attributed to the house itself: _____





As people have become increasingly conscious of their impact on the environment, "green" products—those that have a less negative environmental impact from their production or use, compared to standard products—have been developed for home use, from paint on the walls to sources of heat. While these products often have a larger upfront cost, the positive ecological impact is often not the only benefit. For example, geothermal heat pumps, widely considered the most eco-friendly way to heat a house, _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

12. Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the example?

× A cost less to maintain than any other form of home heating currently available.

× B cost less than half of any other form of home heating to deliver heat per MBtu and are four times more efficient than electric resistance systems.

× C cost less to deliver heat per MBtu than either propane or natural gas furnaces.

× D deliver heat for only slightly less per MBtu than a natural gas furnace and cost much more to install than any other home-heating system.

In the midst of the Romantic period, authors such as Jane Austen and Charlotte Brontë crafted novels that centered around marriage, delving into the complexities of courtship and societal expectations. Austen's *Pride and Prejudice* and Brontë's *Jane Eyre* dedicated substantial attention to exploring the intricacies of romantic relationships and the impact of marriage on individuals' lives. At the same time, such novels challenged convention: women in these stories, as was the case for actual women during the time, had limited agency as they aimed to adhere to the strict rules of courtship, rigid social hierarchies, and restricting gender roles, thus suggesting writers such as Austen and Brontë _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

13. Which choice most logically completes the text?

× A scorned marriage as they stressed the importance of independence and singledom in their novels.

× B acknowledged the importance of marriage while also recognizing the oppressive nature of societal expectations.

× C had extremely modern perspectives for their time and inspired future women writers to expand on themes of societal oppression.

× D likely collaborated to align the themes of their novels in order to emphasize a need for change.

It is often asserted that "history is written by the winners," and for several centuries, the reputation of King Richard III of England has been one of the clearest examples of this claim. Richard III was defeated and killed in 1485 in battle with the soon-to-be Henry VII, and his story was spread by the victorious monarch, who portrayed Richard III as a manipulative, power-hungry tyrant who murdered his own nephews to reach the throne. However, historians in the twentieth century have uncovered physical and documentary evidence that has greatly revised the way Richard III is now portrayed in most history books, and he has been cleared of many earlier accusations. Thus, even if history is initially written by the winners, _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

14. Which choice most logically completes the text?

× A it can still sometimes be rewritten to more accurately reflect the available evidence.

× B Richard III is now remembered more positively than he deserves to be.

× C historians have changed the dominant view, so they control the perspectives of the readers.

× D there is no way to know how our own accomplishments will be viewed by future generations.

A UNESCO World Heritage Site, the Redwood National and State Parks in Northern California provide a home to the Northern spotted _____ by widespread habitat destruction that there are only approximately 3,000 individuals remaining in the wilderness.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

15. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A owl, a species so endangered

× B owl, it is a species so endangered

× C owl and the species is so endangered

× D owl; a species so endangered

_____ the Red-headed woodpecker is surprisingly adept at catching flying insects midair. This shows that what may appear like stark color contrast to the human eye does not necessarily provide a meaningful disadvantage in certain animal feeding behaviors.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

16. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A Known for its crimson head, and snow-white body,

× B Known for its crimson head and snow-white body,

× C Known for its crimson head and snow-white body

× D Known for its crimson head and snow-white body:

Most humans are unaware of the complexity of sonic communication used by various bat species. For instance, the ultrasonic waves (reaching frequencies undetectable to human ears) produced by bat vocalization _____ other bats to gather in caves for safety, breeding, and feeding.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

17. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A causes

× B is causing

× C cause

× D has caused

The circadian rhythm is an internal process that functions as the biological clock of the human body. Since its discovery, biologists have noted how external factors, such as the detection of blue light, can impact _____. Blue light in particular can suppress the production of melatonin, which is directly related to sleep-wake cycles.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

18. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A it

× B them

× C one

× D these

In medieval Europe, people known as Thomists were followers of Thomas Aquinas, a prominent philosopher and theologian who advocated for the integration of reason and faith. Aquinas emphasized that genuine knowledge and spiritual enlightenment could be achieved through a harmonious blending of logical inquiry and philosophical _____ that the ultimate purpose of mankind lies in an understanding of one's own existence.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

19. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A contemplation asserting

× B contemplation. Asserting

× C contemplation, asserting

× D contemplation; asserting

Researchers were able to determine that the average size of many varieties of mosquitoes has varied greatly over the previous twelve thousand years. Another _____ mosquitos evolved to seek out humans exclusively.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

20. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A discovery was, that over time, some,

× B discovery was, that, over time, some

× C discovery, was, that over time, some

× D discovery was that, over time, some

Indian mathematician Srinivasa Ramanujan, a mathematical prodigy, was inspired to study math by a copy of George Shoobridge Carr's *Synopsis of Elementary Results in Pure and Applied Mathematics*. Ramanujan never received formal mathematics training but nevertheless published articles in esteemed academic journals, gaining worldwide recognition for his brilliance. Considered one of the biggest mathematical breakthroughs of the 20th century, _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

21. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A Ramanujan formulated the infinite series of pi, which continues to be used in numerous algorithms today.

× B today Ramanujan's formula for the infinite series of pi continues to be used in numerous applications.

× C numerous applications today use the formula for the infinite series of pi, which was discovered by Ramanujan.

× D Ramanujan's formula for the infinite series of pi continues to be used in numerous algorithms today.

Jacob Lawrence's works, which are showcased in the exhibition "Black Orpheus: Jacob Lawrence and the Mbari Club," serve as a gateway into the vibrant world of 1960s Africa and its diaspora. It explores the intertwined realms of aesthetics, spirituality, and politics, and _____ it unveils the conflicting concerns of African artists as they strive to shape a new postcolonial cultural identity.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

22. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

× A in short,

× B instead,

× C conversely,

× D moreover,

Recent findings on the regions of whale DNA that regulate their size have offered insights that can be applied to a variety of fields. For example, evolutionary biologists have suggested that these genes can yield new observations in regards to the impact of the ocean on evolution, as well as key differences in land mammal and ocean mammal genetics. _____ oncology researchers are interested in the role that these genes may play in cetacean cancer resistance.

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

23. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

× A However,

× B In addition,

× C Actually,

× D Regardless,

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Vineyard Wind 1 is an offshore wind farm under construction about 13 nautical miles off the coast of Massachusetts.
- Vineyard Wind 1 will include 62 wind turbines, providing enough power for about 400,000 local homes.
- The Massachusetts Department of Public Utilities approved the project in 2019, and construction began in November 2021.
- To address environmental concerns, construction will be suspended during whale activity, and the University of New Hampshire will monitor marine mammal sounds to assess potential stress to local marine life.
- The project is expected to both reduce greenhouse gas emissions and reduce electricity costs for Massachusetts consumers.
- The developers will sell the power for $0.09/kWh and agreed to provide $15 million to support the expansion of the electric grid in low-income communities.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

24. The student wants to emphasize a potential benefit and a potential drawback of the Vineyard Wind 1 project. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

✖ A Since Vineyard Wind 1 will be constructed off the coast of Massachusetts, marine animals such as whales may be exposed to higher levels of stress.

✖ B Vineyard Wind 1 will provide enough power for about 400,000 local homes and is expected to reduce electricity costs for Massachusetts consumers.

✖ C Although developers suspended construction during whale activity in the area due to environmental concerns, construction of Vineyard Wind 1 began in November 2021.

✖ D Though Vineyard Wind 1 is expected to lower both greenhouse gas emissions and electricity costs for local residents, there are potential concerns as to how it may affect whales

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The *Bundesautobahn*, or autobahn, is a network of highways in Germany.
- The autobahn covers 13,192 kilometers.
- Famed for its general lack of a speed limit, the autobahn does have enforced speed limits in urbanized or accident-prone areas, which account for 23.4 percent of the total area.
- The autobahn does not have a posted speed limit across 70.4 percent of its distance, but on these stretches of highway, there is an advisory speed limit of 130 kilometers per hour.
- It is legal to exceed the advisory speed limit, but exceeding it can result in increased liability for a driver should a collision occur.
- The autobahn has a fatality rate of just 1.6 deaths per billion travel-kilometers (compared to 4.6 on urban streets in Germany and 6.5 on rural roads in Germany).

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

25. The student wants to explain that a driver could still be penalized directly for driving too fast on the autobahn. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

× A Drivers must obey permanent speed limits on stretches of the autobahn that are in urbanized or accident-prone areas or risk a speeding citation.

× B If a driver exceeding the 'advisory' speed limit collides with another vehicle, his or her automobile insurer will be liable for damages arising from the accident.

× C Drivers are free to drive as fast as they want on nearly three-fourths of the autobahn.

× D Despite its lack of an enforced speed limit on approximately 70 percent of its network, the autobahn boasts a lower fatality rate than do urban streets or rural roads in Germany.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Shakespeare's plays are known for their enduring popularity and widespread influence.
- The most recognized and frequently performed Shakespearean plays include *Romeo and Juliet*, *Hamlet*, and *Macbeth*.
- Shakespeare's works have been translated into numerous languages and performed in various countries worldwide.
- While it is hard to quantify the exact number of adaptations, there are at least over 30 film adaptations of *Romeo and Juliet*.
- There are at least over 50 film adaptations of *Hamlet*.
- *The Tragedy of Macbeth* is a movie adaptation of *Macbeth* that was released in 2021.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

26. A student wants to convey the relevancy of Shakespeare's plays in the modern age. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

✖ A Shakespeare's plays continue to remain popular, as proven by the frequent performances, translations into multiple languages, and the constant stream of new film adaptations.

✖ B Shakespeare's plays include *Romeo and Juliet*, *Hamlet*, and *Macbeth*, among many others that he has penned.

✖ C While Shakespeare's plays are considered to be well-known, it is hard to measure the extent of their influence on other literary and non-literary works.

✖ D Out of all the Shakespearean plays, *Hamlet* is perhaps the most popular, with over 50 film adaptations to date, though this does not account for the number of theater performances.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- M104, also known as the Sombrero Galaxy, is a lenticular galaxy, and is considered to be one of the largest objects within the Virgo galaxy cluster.
- The Sombrero Galaxy has a bright nucleus, a bulging center, and a prominent dark dust lane that crosses in front of it, giving it the appearance of a wide-brimmed hat on its edge.
- The Sombrero Galaxy has a diameter of about 49,000 light-years and lies approximately 31.1 million light-years from Earth.
- With an apparent magnitude of +8.0, the Sombrero Galaxy can be observed using amateur astronomy telescopes.
- The estimated mass of the Sombrero Galaxy is equivalent to 800 billion suns.
- In 2004, NASA released a mosaic photo of the Sombrero Galaxy, one of the largest mosaics ever assembled by images captured by the Hubble telescope.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

27. The student wants to emphasize a feature of the Sombrero Galaxy that describes its specific shape. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish these goals?

× A The Sombrero Galaxy has a diameter of about 49,000 light-years and an estimated mass equivalent to 800 billion suns.

× B The Sombrero Galaxy is one of the largest objects in the Virgo galaxy cluster and can be spotted with an amateur telescope.

× C The Sombrero Galaxy, characterized by a bright nucleus with a bulging center, has an appearance reminiscent of a wide-brimmed hat.

× D The Sombrero Galaxy is easily visible with amateur astronomy telescopes due to its apparent magnitude of +8.0.

MODULE 2

Slugs have developed different strategies for protection, such as producing mucus to _____ predators or to traverse difficult terrain. The mucus secreted by slugs serves as a deterrent to predators due to the added difficulty in hunting and unpleasant taste, discouraging potential attackers from targeting them.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

1. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

× A guide

× B deter

× C combat

× D confuse

Despite the _____ of information from national news sources about the railway disaster, details about the train derailment spread quickly via social media sites. Many users lambasted news outlets and federal officials alike, criticizing them for a lack of public acknowledgement of the accident and failure to address the potential environmental and public health consequences for nearby communities.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

2. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

× A abundance

× B paucity

× C quality

× D inaccuracy

During the winter of 1858, a 34-year-old French acrobat Charles Blondin traveled to Niagara Falls with the ambition to become the first person to cross the falls on a 1,300-foot tightrope suspended above the churning waters below. Blondin had always worked without a net, confidently asserting that preparing for disaster only made one more likely to occur, but journalists and gamblers alike doubted the potential success of such a seemingly brazen act of _____.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

3. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A hubris

B insolence

C shrewdness

D joviality

Lady Katherine Grey was a Tudor noblewoman and the younger sister of Lady Jane Grey, who briefly reigned as Queen of England. Despite her own claim to the throne and her royal bloodline, Lady Katherine's life was marked by tragedy and _____. Because she married without the Queen's permission, Lady Katherine faced harsh punishments, including imprisonment in the Tower of London.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

4. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A passivity

B rancor

C inanity

D acumen

The emergence of digital platforms has caused significant _____ in established industries. One notable example lies in the hospitality sector, which traditionally has been dominated by hotels. However, the emergence of Airbnb introduced a novel form of accommodation within the sharing economy, commonly referred to as peer-to-peer accommodation. This innovative model enabled individuals to leverage a dedicated platform to rent out their spare rooms, thus revolutionizing the way people access lodging options.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

5. Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

× A provocation

× B disruption

× C vexation

× D concession

The following text is from Charles Dickens's 1861 novel *Great Expectations*. Pip meets Miss Havisham, a wealthy spinster, for the first time.

<u>But I saw that everything within my view which ought to be white, had been white long ago, and had lost its lustre and was faded and yellow.</u> I saw that the bride within the bridal dress had withered like the dress, and like the flowers, and had no brightness left but the brightness of her sunken eyes. I saw that the dress had been put upon the rounded figure of a young woman, and that the figure upon which it now hung loose had shrunk to skin and bone.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

6. Which choice best describes the function of the underlined portion in the text as a whole?

× A It conveys the sense of disgust the narrator feels regarding his surroundings.

× B It establishes a juxtaposition between past and present and elaborates on the contrast.

× C It depicts the decay and fading of physical objects and makes a connection to the narrator's sense of foreboding.

× D It emphasizes the narrator's fascination with macabre concepts by focusing on the withered flowers and scenery.

John Steinbeck's concern with the hardships of migrant farm workers during the Great Depression culminated in the 1939 novel *The Grapes of Wrath*, an expansive social saga that many critics regard as the American author's masterpiece. Remarkable in scope, this book is the product of what, to Steinbeck, felt like a series of false starts. Mere years before he composed *The Grapes of Wrath*, Steinbeck penned L'Affaire Lettuceberg, a darkly satirical portrayal of the injustices that farm workers faced. He ultimately decided not to publish this work and destroyed its manuscript. Steinbeck also composed a 1930s play featuring impoverished farm workers as its protagonists. This text, too, never reached the press and has not survived.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

7. Which choice best describes the purpose of the text?

✖ A To note parallels between *The Grapes of Wrath* and a few of Steinbeck's unpublished writings

✖ B To contrast Steinbeck's *The Grapes of Wrath* with some of the author's less ambitious projects

✖ C To show how Steinbeck's approach to writing evolved during the composition of *The Grapes of Wrath*

✖ D To imply that the Steinbeck publications that followed *The Grapes of Wrath* were dissatisfying to Steinbeck himself

Text 1

The Baader–Meinhof phenomenon, also known as frequency illusion, occurs when something recently learned or experienced seems to suddenly appear everywhere. This creates a sense of heightened awareness towards that new idea, whether it's exposure to a new word or new artist on the radio. Consequently, individuals may perceive an increased frequency of encounters with the new concept in their lives.

Text 2

Cognitive biases are systematic patterns of deviation from objective rationality in thinking processes. They are inherent shortcuts and tendencies employed by the brain to facilitate decision-making and judgment formation, though they can lead to distortions in perception. Such biases are typically unconscious and can influence information processing and pattern recognition.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

8. Based on the texts, what would the author of Text 2 say about the Baader–Meinhof phenomenon?

✖ A It is a result of heightened awareness towards new ideas, leading to increased encounters, so it is not related to cognitive bias.

✖ B It is a form of cognitive bias that distorts perceptions and judgments, but it is not specifically related to increased encounters with recently learned concepts.

✖ C It is an example of a cognitive bias because it is related to perception and pattern recognition, leading one to perceive an increased frequency of encounters.

✖ D It is a problematic phenomenon that is somewhat similar to cognitive bias because it leads to a deviation from logical judgment formation.

Laws often include exceptions for cultural reasons. In Ontario, Canada, there are environmental regulations that limit certain hunting and fishing activities. However, the First Nations people, who have a long-standing history of hunting and fishing in the region, are generally granted exemptions from these restrictions. Though both environmental and hunting groups have attempted to change these regulations and exceptions, thus far the courts and legislative bodies have maintained such exemptions due to the cultural significance of these activities for First Nations.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

9. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

✖ A Environmental groups believe hunting and fishing should be restricted for environmental reasons with no exceptions.

✖ B Laws regarding hunting and fishing should always allow for cultural exceptions.

✖ C Exceptions to hunting and fishing regulations in Ontario are an example of a culturally-based legal exemption.

✖ D Restrictions placed for environmental reasons must include exceptions based on the culture of indigenous peoples.

Discussions of the “all-time greatest” basketball players resurface whenever a major record is broken or a notable athlete retires. However, such debates often reveal more about the values of the commentator than they do about the athletes being discussed. For example, one may argue that Michael Jordan deserves the title of greatest player due to his six championships, but this criteria would also include many Celtics players from the 1960s, led by Bill Russell with his eleven championships. On the other hand, if the focus is on points scored, then LeBron James could be considered the best player of all time, though this approach would rank players like Karl Malone and Kareem Abdul-Jabbar above Kobe Bryant and Michael Jordan, which few people would agree with. Ultimately, even if multiple factors are taken into account, the relative importance of each factor is a matter of personal opinion.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

10. Which choice best states the main idea of the text?

✖ A Debates about the greatest basketball player of all time may shed more light on the values of the participants than on the actual subject matter.

✖ B Arguments over the greatest basketball player are pointless exercises since no answer will be agreed upon.

✖ C No basketball player can be argued to be the greatest of all time because there are too many factors to consider.

✖ D Either Bill Russell or LeBron James is the greatest basketball player, depending on whether championship wins or points scored are deemed more significant.

In a research paper, a student challenges the prevailing narratives surrounding Marie Curie, the renowned physicist and chemist, arguing that her legacy has been predominantly examined through the lens of gender and societal barriers, rather than an in-depth analysis of her groundbreaking scientific contributions.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

11. Which quotation from a work by a historian would most effectively illustrate the student's claim?

✖ A "Marie Curie became the first female professor at Sorbonne University and was nominated for membership of the Académie des sciences in Paris, France, which had never been awarded to a woman before."

✖ B "While Marie Curie certainly defied the gender norms of the time, she was an accomplished scientist in her own right and she created a new field of study through her research."

✖ C "By challenging the status quo, Marie Curie became an iconic figure, symbolizing the triumph of determination and resilience in the face of societal barriers."

✖ D "Marie Curie encountered the same challenges that scientists grapple with today, such as limited financial resources as well as juggling between personal responsibilities and dedicated research time."

The Birds is a comedy play by Aristophanes, first performed in 414 BCE. In the play, the character Peithetairos is motivated by a desire to empower the people who join him in his utopian city in the sky so that they may reach new heights of knowledge: _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

12. Which translated quotation from *The Birds* most effectively illustrates the claim?

× A "To begin with, 'tis the foe and not the friend that taught cities to build high walls, to equip long vessels of war; and 'tis this knowledge that protects our children, our slaves and our wealth."

× B "I am beginning to see a great plan, which will transfer the supreme power to the birds, if you will but take my advice."

× C "Words give wings to the mind and make a man soar to heaven. Thus I hope that my wise words will give you wings to fly to some less degrading trade."

× D "I have groaned over the treachery of our fathers, who knew not how to transmit to us the high rank they held from their forefathers."

Region	Number of Bird Species	Number of Bee Species
Native Forest	35	16
Traditional Agriculture	24	13
Monocultural Agriculture	5	6

One of the most important ways that ecologists evaluate the health of an ecosystem is by its ability to maintain its biodiversity. However, as agriculture continues to industrialize in the ongoing effort to provide food for the Earth's growing population, certain regions are dominated by monocultural models, in which plant biodiversity is deliberately limited in order to maximize output of certain crops. However, this practice may also limit the biodiversity of other species, possibly leading to impacts beyond what is currently visible. For example, one recent study found that species of birds and bees, which greatly contribute to biodiversity in a habitat, _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

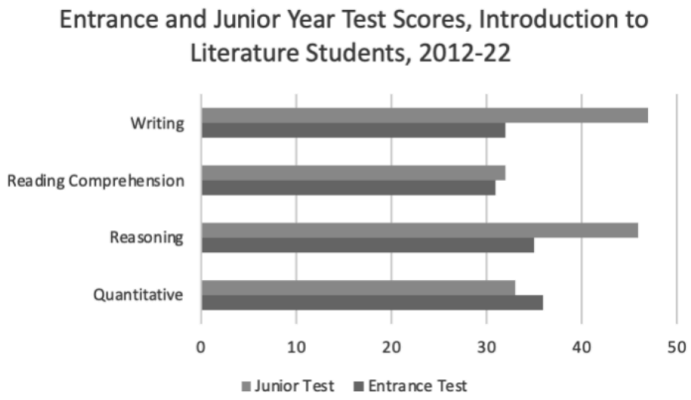
13. Which choice most effectively uses data from the table to complete the example?

× A are less varied in native forest regions than in monocultural agricultural regions.

× B are less varied in agricultural regions than in forested regions.

× C are less impacted by regions dominated by monocultural agriculture than other regions.

× D are not nearly as varied in monocultural regions than in either forested or traditional agricultural regions.



While the required classes for all undergraduates at State University may not always result in significant improvements in their target areas, they have been shown to have positive effects in other domains. For example, students who took the required math course actually demonstrated a slight decrease in mathematics scores, though their reasoning skills significantly improved by the end of their junior year. Perhaps the most surprising example is that the completion of the required literature course _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

14. Which choice most effectively uses data from the graph to complete the example?

× A had a negligible impact on reading comprehension scores, but students demonstrated strong improvement on both reasoning and writing.

× B had a negative impact on reading comprehension scores but a positive impact on quantitative scores.

× C led to the least improvement on reading comprehension of any required class but had an overall positive effect on test scores.

× D led to the strongest overall improvement on test scores of any required class but had the least impact on reading comprehension.

Determining whether Neanderthals used spoken language is difficult due to the absence of preserved voice box tissue. However, the shape of a Neanderthals skull can offer some clues. A high arch in the skull base, as is the case with modern humans, suggests a low-positioned larynx, allowing for the production of the diverse sounds used in speech.

At a glance, Neanderthal skull bases appear to be less arched than those of modern humans but more arched than those of modern apes. Researchers gained an additional piece to the puzzle when they discovered a fossilized hyoid bone belonging to a Neanderthal that possessed a similar structure to modern humans. Because this particular bone supports the tongue, some researchers believe it functions to assist with sound production. Therefore, _____

PREV. QUESTION | NEXT QUESTION

15. Which choice most logically completes the text?

✖ A even though Neanderthals possessed most of the anatomical features required to produce speech sounds, they likely lacked the ability to produce loud sounds.

✖ B Neanderthals likely would have been able to produce the same range of sounds as humans today, as evidenced by the discovery of the hyoid bone.

✖ C Neanderthals would not have been able to produce speech sounds any more than an ape could, but they likely could produce basic vocalizations like grunting.

✖ D Neanderthals would have had the ability to produce certain speech sounds, although they likely did not possess the full range of sounds utilized by modern humans.

In his seminal essay "The Four Idols," Francis Bacon develops a case for the necessity of a scientific approach that mitigates the effect of "idols" that impede the human ability to think rationally. Bacon argues that humans tend to perceive reality through the lens of preconceived notions, such as an Aristotelian understanding of nature or a religious or political ideology. He refers to these mental frameworks as "idols of theater," which can distort one's perception and inhibit objective thought. Thus, according to Bacon, in order to think with rational clarity, _____

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

16. Which choice most logically completes the text?

× A humans must not have any existing thought system.

× B humans must sometimes be willing to put aside previous assumptions.

× C humans must commit to the correct thought system.

× D humans must commit to a system of thought and maintain consistency within it.

At just twenty-six years old, author R.F. Kuang has achieved commendable success with her novels. Her most recent work, *Yellowface*, received immediate praise, adding to the popularity she gained with her well-received *Poppy War* series and *Babel*, a tale rooted in the dark academia aesthetic. Ironically, although *Yellowface* harshly criticizes the publishing industry, Kuang's publisher HarperCollins _____ happy to offer a six-figure deal.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

17. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A are

× B was

× C were

× D have been

Neil Armstrong is famous for being the first man to set foot on the _____ in the iconic photograph is actually Buzz Aldrin. The editors of TIME Magazine have adjusted the caption for future printings and have acknowledged the correction in subsequent editions.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

18. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A moon; however, the astronaut

× B moon, the astronaut

× C moon, however; the astronaut

× D moon: but the astronaut

As Beethoven's Ninth Symphony nears its conclusion, the Adagio _____ into a triumphant finale, weaving together themes from earlier movements and culminating in the exultant "Ode to Joy." This iconic coda stands as a testament to Beethoven's genius, showcasing his mastery of musical form and expression.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

19. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A transforms

× B would transform

× C transformed

× D will transform

The natural world might appear to be in hibernation during winter, which may discourage birdwatchers and other wildlife enthusiasts from exploring national parks. Experienced observers can spot uniquely wintry signs of _____ the distinct footprints of rabbits, porcupines and other small mammals, as well as the variety of birds' nests left in barren trees, are best appreciated against the stark white backdrop of a fresh layer of snow, according to veteran explorers.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

20. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A life, however,

× B life however,

× C life, however;

× D life; however,

At the outset of his novel *Bleak House*, Charles Dickens establishes a gloomy and gothic mood befitting of its title; unfortunately, this leads many readers to overlook the comedic _____, particularly its satirical depiction of the Victorian period's legal system.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

21. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A elements of Dickens's novel

× B elements of Dicken's novel

× C element's of a Dicken's novel

× D elements' of a Dickens' novel

A team of researchers led by Ihab Mikati conducted a study to measure and analyze differences in the distribution of facilities across the US that emit particulate matter, which can contain harmful irritants such as dust or soot. They concluded that there _____ disparities depending on the geographic location, thereby suggesting that there are certain populations that may face higher levels of exposure compared to others.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

22. Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

× A are in fact,

× B are, in fact,

× C are, in fact:

× D are in fact

The Paris Commune was an attempt by French republicans to overthrow the royalist French government. The rebels took control of the city but never created a coherent organization, and government troops crushed the insurrection within two months. _____ the government arrested over 38,000 revolutionaries and deported more than 7,000 people.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

23. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

× A Nevertheless,

× B Surprisingly,

× C Afterward,

× D Still,

Even Marcel Duchamp's skeptics—who hesitate to attribute talent to him—agree it is difficult to imagine the artistic landscape of the past century without his influence. The celebrity images repurposed by Andy Warhol and the public graffiti spray-painted by Banksy, _____ owe a debt to Duchamp's deconstruction of established artistic boundaries.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

24. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

× A for instance,

× B however,

× C in other words,

× D by contrast,

Ammonite shells consist mostly of calcium carbonate, which contains varying amounts of two distinct oxygen isotopes. The ratio of these isotopes depends on the temperature of the surrounding water when the shell was formed. _____ scientists consider ammonites to be environmental historical "records" because the shells act as sensitive indicators of their original environments and can be compared to each other in efforts to track local climate change over time.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

25. Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

× A However,

× B For this reason,

× C Meanwhile,

× D On the other hand,

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Alpaca fleece is the natural fiber harvested from an alpaca, a species of South American camelid mammal.
- There are two different types of alpaca fleece: Huacaya fiber, which looks similar to sheep's wool, and Suri fiber, which is similar to natural silk.
- Huacaya fiber is warmer and softer than sheep's wool, and it contains no lanolin, which makes it hypoallergenic.
- Alpaca fiber is naturally water-repellent and fire resistant.
- The designer Giorgio Armani has used Suri alpaca fiber to fashion men's and women's suits.
- The General Assembly of the United Nations declared 2009 to be the International Year of Natural Fibers, intending to increase awareness of alpaca and other natural fibers.

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

26. The student wants to highlight a difference between sheep's wool and alpaca fibers. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

× A One of the two types of alpaca fleece, Huacaya fiber, contains no lanolin and is therefore hypoallergenic.

× B While Huacaya fiber looks similar to sheep's wool, Suri fiber is preferred due to its similar texture to natural silk.

× C Alpaca fiber is naturally water-repellent and fire-resistant.

× D Although Huacaya fiber looks similar to sheep's wool, it is both warmer and softer.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Dialectometry studies the variance of languages across regions by measuring the relationship between geographic distance and linguistic differences.
- This variance includes phonetics, grammar, and vocabulary.
- Linguistic variables are charted on a dialect map to identify patterns.
- An isogloss is a line of a dialect map that marks the boundary between linguistic features.
- Lexical variation refers to the use of different words to describe the same thing.
- Dialectologists found that approximately 44% of UK residents use “dinner” to refer to their evening meal, 52% use “tea,” and the rest use “supper.”

PREV. QUESTION NEXT QUESTION

27. A student wants to provide an example of how a dialectologist might depict linguistic variations based on location. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

✖ A A dialectologist could study how language varies across regions by examining the correlation between geographic distance and linguistic differences.

✖ B A dialectologist could create an isogloss, marking the boundaries between different linguistic features, in order to illustrate regional variations in how UK residents refer to their evening meal.

✖ C Isoglosses are lines on a dialect map that show different linguistic features, helping dialectologists identify common patterns, such as the words people use and how they pronounce words.

✖ D Lexical variation is one example of dialectometry and refers to the use of different words to describe the same thing, as observed in the case of UK residents using different terms for their evening meal.